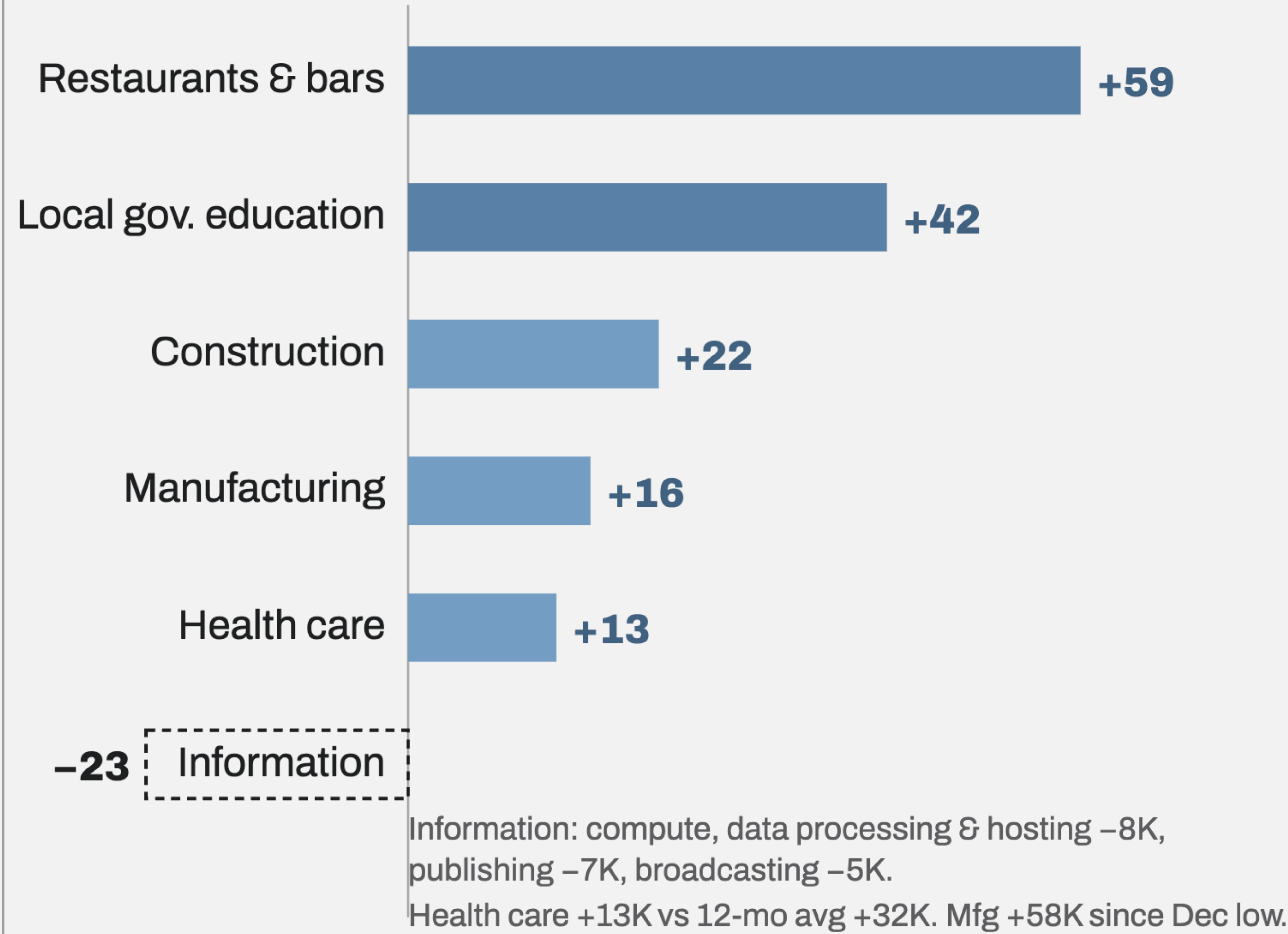


Payrolls jump

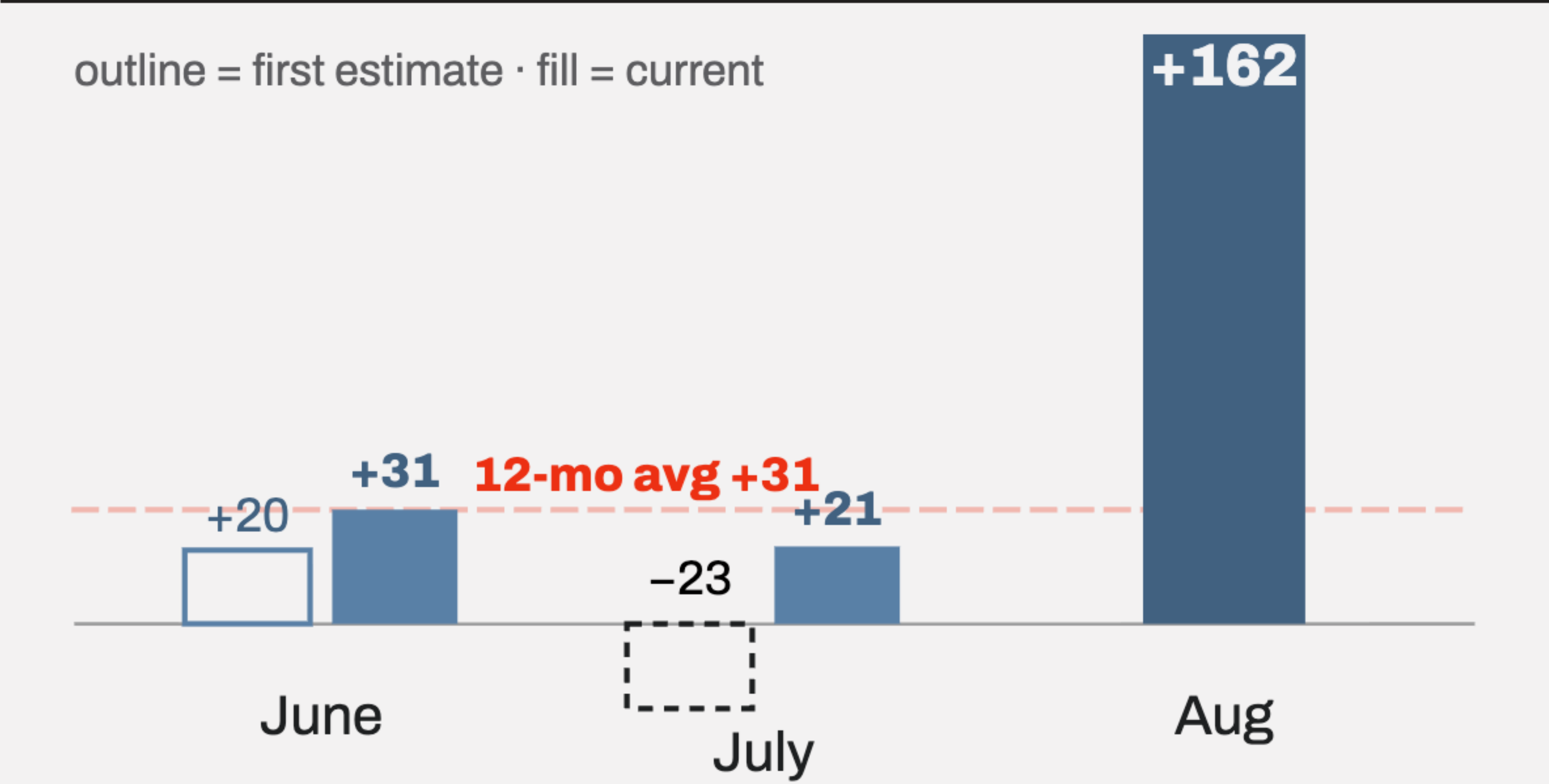
+162,000, five times the 12-month pace

Unemployment held at 4.1%. June and July were revised up by a combined 55,000, flipping July from a loss (–23K) to a gain (+21K). Gains were broad-based; information was the only major industry to shed jobs.

WHERE THE JOBS WERE · CHANGE IN AUGUST, THOUSANDS



REVISIONS · TOTAL NONFARM, THOUSANDS



4.1%

Unemployment rate, unchanged · 7.0M unemployed

7.7%

U-6 underemployment, lowest since Jun 2025

\$37.75

Avg hourly earnings · +0.3% m/m · +3.1% y/y

61.6%

Participation, up on the month; –0.5 pt since Jan

HOUSEHOLD SURVEY
+569K employed, **+683K** joined the labor force

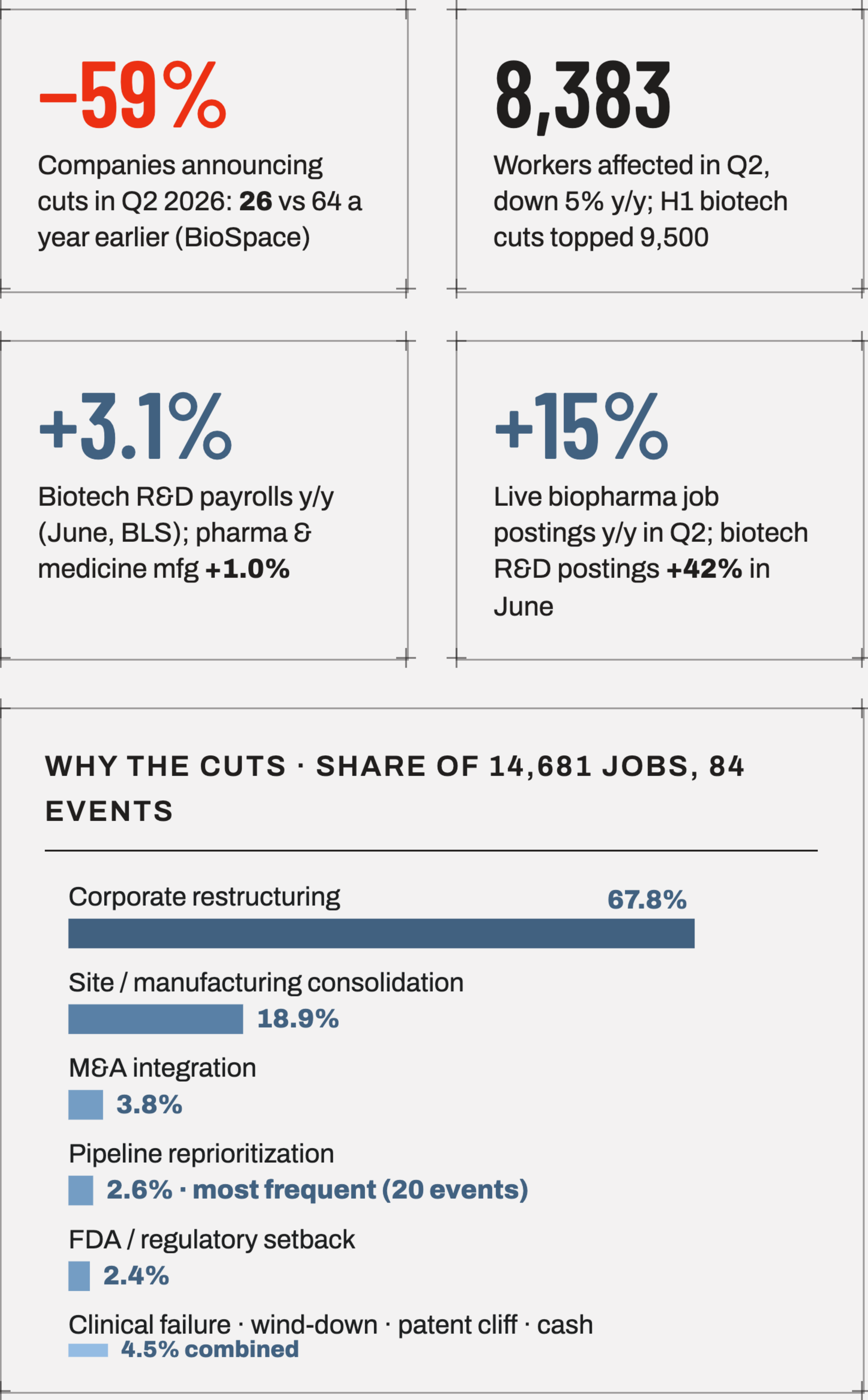
INVOLUNTARY PART-TIME
–414K to 4.4M

WORKWEEK
34.4 hrs, +0.1 · mfg 40.5 hrs

LONG-TERM UNEMPLOYED
1.9M · 27.0% of all unemployed

Biopharma: fewer cuts, payrolls still growing, a barbell market

Layoff announcements fell sharply in Q2 while BLS payrolls in biotech R&D and drug manufacturing kept rising. Cuts are concentrated in Big Pharma restructuring and in New Jersey, Massachusetts and the Bay Area; specialist roles remain hard to fill.



LARGEST 2026 REDUCTIONS · WHERE AND WHY		
COMPANY	JOBS	WHERE · WHY
Takeda	~4,500	Global · FY26 transformation, fewer management layers
Viatis	3,200	~10% of staff over 3 yrs · \$600–700M savings
BioNTech	~1,860	Germany, Singapore · four manufacturing sites closing
Novartis	792+	East Hanover NJ (>half), Wehr DE, Basel · restructuring
Bristol Myers	453	Lawrenceville NJ · two WARN rounds
Sanofi / Blueprint	229	Cambridge MA · post-acquisition integration
Replimune	224	Massachusetts · two FDA rejections, 60% of staff
Gilead / Arcellx	192	Redwood City CA, Rockville MD · 87% of acquired staff
CONTRACTING		EXPANDING
Big Pharma corporate functions and field sales; sites in NJ, MA and the Bay Area; neurology, oncology and gene-therapy programs after trial or FDA setbacks.		Biotech R&D headcount (+3.1% y/y) and drug manufacturing (+1.0%). Senior regulatory and cell & gene therapy CMC searches run 6–9 months.

Why

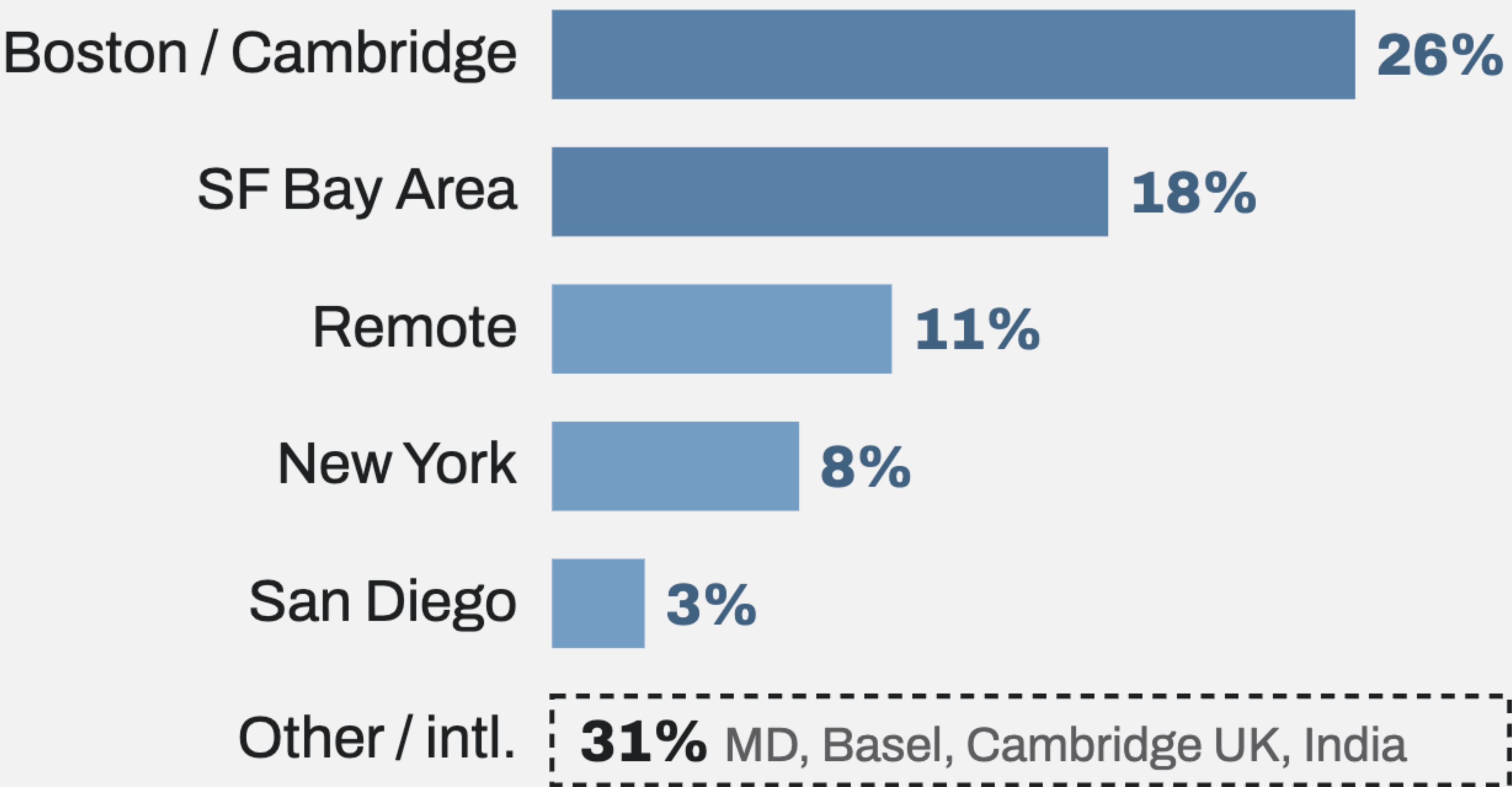
Patent expirations, drug-pricing pressure (most-favored-nation proposals, IRA negotiation) and post-pandemic capacity realignment drive the Big Pharma programs; small biotechs cut after clinical misses, FDA complete response letters and acquisitions. Restructuring explains 68% of jobs lost but only 30% of events.

Invisible to BLS.

631 roles in the postings data.

BLS has no code for our profession; these jobs are scattered across pharma manufacturing, R&D services, hospitals and software. Career-page scrapes are the only view, and one in five postings economy-wide is a ghost. Read the composition, not the totals.

WHERE THE ROLES SIT · SHARE OF Q2 POSTINGS



OUR TITLES · POSTINGS AND POSTED PAY, Q2

ROLE	POSTS	AVG RANGE
Biostatistician / Stat programmer	80	\$134–201K sr.
Data Scientist (Bioinformatics)	75	\$118–173K mid
Computational Biologist	53	\$134–201K sr.
ML / AI Scientist (Bio)	49	\$288–570K top
Bioinformatician / AI bioinformatician	49	\$118–173K mid
Genomics / NGS	27	\$118–173K mid
Protein design / structural	18	\$160–245K prin.

Categories overlap. ML/AI is 8% of postings but holds the three highest-paid roles. Mix skews senior: 156 Senior/Staff, 97 Director, 91 Principal vs 5 interns.

WHO POSTED · Q2 2026

EMPLOYER	ROLES	FOCUS
Genentech	48	AI/ML, oncology, structural bio
Gilead	31	Clinical data science
AstraZeneca	30	Stat programming, genomics
Dana-Farber	29	Cancer genomics
Bristol Myers Squibb	27	Translational AI/ML
Novartis	26	AI platform, data science
Flagship / Lila Sciences	24	AI drug discovery · to \$570K

IS THE POSTING REAL? FIVE CHECKS

- Age.** Live over 30 days or reappearing with identical text and req ID: pipeline building, not a search.
- Pay range.** 69% of comp-bio posts now disclose. No range at a CA/NY/MA employer is a flag.
- Career page + verified badge.** Board-only listings that never appear on the employer's own site.
- Repost with changes** (raised band, PhD dropped to MS) = hard to fill. Repost unchanged = ghost.
- Agency multiples.** One client req released to 4–5 staffing vendors via a VMS = 4–5 postings, one seat. Same JD, different logos, hourly rates that differ by vendor margin. Contract posts +94% y/y vs full-time +5%.

GHOST JOBS

18–22% of postings, any platform

HIRES PER 10 POSTS

8 → 4, 2019 vs 2024

APPLICANTS PER POST

4.4, down from 5.0 in Q1

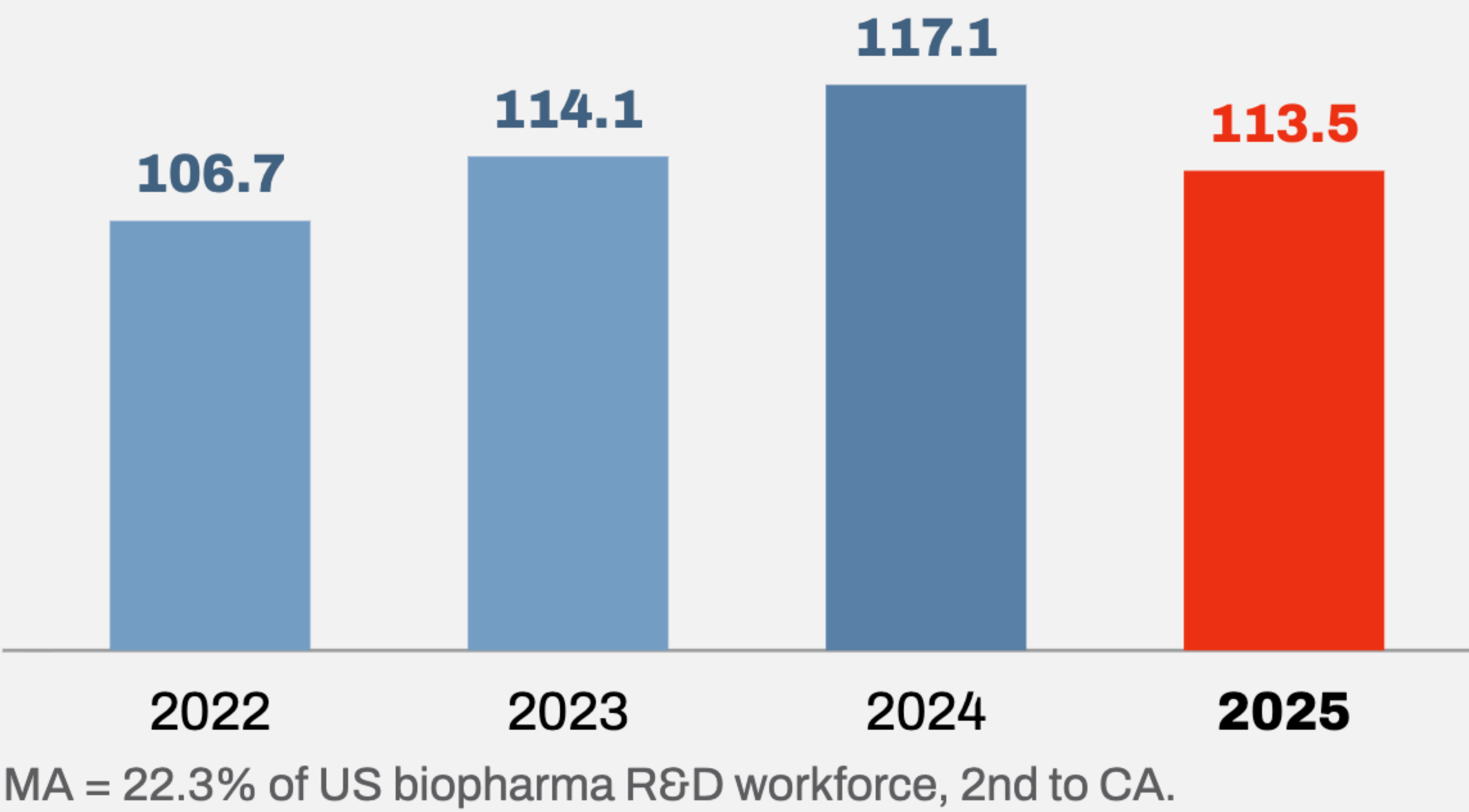
SALARY DISCLOSED

69% of posts, up from 56%

Postings up 15%. Headcount fell 3.1%.

MASSACHUSETTS BIOPHARMA · JOBS, THOUSANDS

Axis truncated. 2025: -3.1%, ≈3,600 jobs, first fall since 2008.



Adding in 2026

Lilly 540 → 1,423 · Sanofi +385 · Vertex, Pfizer, Alnylam, AbbVie, Biogen · biomanufacturing +238

Cutting in 2026

Moderna ≈ -1,400, post-COVID normalisation · seed rounds down to \$4.65M avg

HUB RANKINGS · DO THE SOURCES AGREE?

RANK	CBRE · R&D TALENT (BLS)	BIOSPACE · LIVE POSTS	COMPBIO · Q2 SHARE
1	Boston-Cambridge	Massachusetts	Boston 26%
2	SF Bay Area	New Jersey	Bay Area 18%
3	DC-Baltimore	California	Remote 11%
4	New York-New Jersey	New York	New York 8%
↑	Madison, Dallas, San Diego, Raleigh	Indiana	San Diego 3%

Three methods, one answer on the top two. National core life-sciences payrolls posted their strongest growth in nearly three years in early 2026 (CBRE).

THE 2025 TROUGH THE RECOVERY STARTS FROM

JOBS LIVE Y/Y	Q1 · Q2 · Q3 · Q4 2025
California	-28% · -30% · -48% · -51%
Massachusetts	-2% · -25% · -48% · -28%

Q2 2026 +15% y/y is measured against these lows. Lightcast is the one source publishing **unique** postings and a posting-intensity ratio (total ÷ unique) — the direct measure of agency multiples.

The worst is over. The rebound isn't here yet. Apply senior, verify everything, judge again in December.

MA VENTURE, H1 2026
\$3.45B, +25% y/y · 25% of US total

MA IPOS, H1 2026
8, equal to 2024 + 2025 combined

LAB VACANCY
≈ 1/3 of Boston-area lab space empty

NEXT HARD DATA
QCEW Q2, NAICS 5417 / 3254, ~Dec 2026